

Marketing Weekly Compendium 2023 – Full Summary

Prepared for: Tata Consumer Products PPI –
Technical Competence Round (MT Role)

HOW TO USE THIS DOCUMENT

Part 1 is a topic-by-topic summary of everything in the compendium (242 slides, ~30 topics).

Part 2 translates this into the questions you're actually likely to get, given your profile:

2-month intern, India Sales division, Pharma sector, TCP – territories: Vadodara, Ahmedabad, Surat.

Since Round 1 was about the MT role itself, Round 2 (Technical Competence) will test whether you understand the *sales & distribution engine* you worked inside, not just marketing theory.

PART 1: TOPIC-WISE SUMMARY

1. Fundamentals of Marketing

- **Marketing** = meeting consumer demand profitably; a **pull** strategy – you create demand and prospects come to you.

- **Selling** = convincing a prospect to buy; a **push** strategy — used when differentiation is hard (telecom, insurance).
- **Marketing vs Selling:** Marketing is customer-centric/pull/long-term; Selling is product-centric/push/short-term.

2. Marketing Mix (4P / 7P)

- **Product:** 3 levels — Core (intended benefit), Actual (features, quality, branding, packaging), Augmented (warranty, after-sales, credit, delivery).
- **Price:** Promotional, Dynamic, Penetration, Psychological, Economy, Premium, Freemium, Bundle pricing.
- **Place:** Direct sales, indirect channels (one-level/hybrid/multi-channel), e-commerce.
- **Promotion:** Sales Promotion (discounts, BTL, bundles) vs Marketing Promotion (campaigns, sponsorships).
- **7P (services)** adds: **People** (staff delivering the service), **Process** (steps to deliver service), **Physical Evidence** (branding/environment — uniforms, service centers, website).
- Worked examples in the deck: iPhone 14 Pro Max, Vaseline, McDonald's (7P).

3. Segmentation, Targeting, Positioning (STP)

- **Segmentation:** breaking a mass market into groups with common needs — Geographic, Demographic, Psychographic, Behavioural.

- **MSADA test** for a good segment: **M**easurable, **S**ubstantial, **A**ccessible, **D**ifferentiable, **A**ctionable.
- **Targeting**: choosing which segments to serve (product specialization vs market specialization).
- **Positioning**: owning a distinct idea in the consumer's mind (Volvo = Safety, ENO = 6-second relief).
 - **POD (Points of Difference)**: unique, owned attributes.
 - **POP (Points of Parity)**: shared attributes — Category POPs (table stakes), Correlational POPs (side-effects of a positive, e.g. "cheap = maybe low quality"), Competitive POPs (neutralizing a rival's POD).
- Examples used: Marriott's multi-brand segmentation, ITC Hotels' 4-brand ladder (ITC/Welcomhotel/Fortune/WelcomHeritage).

4. Product Mix

- **Product Line**: variants of one product under one brand (e.g., Oreo flavors).
- **Product Line Length**: number of products in one line.
- **Product Line Width**: number of parallel product lines.
- **Product Mix Width**: sum of all lines across all categories (e.g., HUL/Unilever's full portfolio).
- **SKU**: Stock Keeping Unit — a specific pack size/variant (Maggi 70g, 280g, 420g are 3 SKUs).
- Worked examples: Xiaomi, ITC (Aashirvaad, Sunfeast, Yippee, Bingo, Classmate, Engage...), Vaseline's full sub-range.

5. Advertising Types — ATL / BTL / TTL

	ATL	BTL	TTL
Target	Mass/undifferentiated	Specific segment	Mass + focused conversion
Media	TV, Radio, Print, Billboards	Flyers, door-to-door, events, SMS	Digital/360° combining both
Response measurement	Hard to measure	Easy (direct)	Easier than ATL

- FMCG uses ATL heavily for brand recall; BTL is used for footfall/conversion at colleges, societies, high-traffic zones.

6. Sales & Distribution Management (core for your role)

Flow: Factory → C&F Agent (logistics) → Warehouse/Depot → Stockist/Distributor (urban) or Super-Stockist (rural) → Wholesaler → Retailer → Consumer, with parallel Modern Trade and E-commerce routes.

Three sale types (critical distinction – expect this question):

- **Primary Sales:** Company → Distributor/Stockist.
- **Secondary Sales:** Distributor/Stockist → Retailer/Dealer.
- **Tertiary Sales:** Retailer/Dealer → Consumer (what actually reflects real market demand – MTs are usually judged on driving secondary/tertiary, not just primary billing).

Key roles:

- **C&F Agent:** transport/logistics partner; charges by distance, speed, and special handling (e.g., cold chain — relevant for pharma).
- **Stockist/Distributor (urban):** services retailers directly; also sells bulk to wholesalers.
- **Super-Stockist (rural):** bulk-supplies rural wholesalers; extends reach to deep rural markets; gets extra freight incentives.
- **Wholesaler:** multi-brand, serves small/remote outlets; companies often try to reduce dependence on wholesalers as they erode price control.
- **Modern Trade** (DMart, Big Bazaar): supplied directly, cutting distributor margin, letting MT pass savings to consumers as discounts.
- **Margin concept:** every channel member earns a cut — e.g., a ₹5 chocolate bar might split ~1% C&F, ~2% distributor, ~5% retailer.

7. Planogram (Shelf Science)

- **Product sequencing:** shoppers scan left-to-right; hero SKUs placed left.
- **Belt-to-eye level:** eye level = "buying level" for high-margin/new items; kids' items (candy, toys) at belt-to-eye level *of a child*.
- **Vertical planogram:** different brands stacked by shelf level, big packs low/small packs high.
- **Horizontal planogram:** same category, different brands, same eye-level — enables comparison shopping.

- Candy near the checkout counter = classic impulse-buy placement.

8. Strategic Frameworks

SWOT

- X-axis: Helpful vs Harmful; Y-axis: Internal (S,W) vs External (O,T) — a commonly missed nuance.
- Worked examples: HUL-type FMCG SWOT (deep rural distribution as strength; D2C brands like Beardo/mCaffeine and private labels as threats) and Vaseline's SWOT.

BCG Matrix (Growth-Share Matrix)

- Axes: Relative Market Share (x) vs Market Growth Rate (y).
- **Stars** (high share, high growth) — invest; **Cash Cows** (high share, low growth) — harvest/fund the rest; **Question Marks** (low share, high growth) — invest selectively or divest; **Dogs** (low share, low growth) — divest or revamp.
- Limitation: only 2 dimensions; ignores inter-portfolio dependencies (a "Dog" might feed raw material to a "Star").
- Worked examples: Tata Group portfolio (TCS/Titan=Stars, Tata Steel=Cash Cow, Tata Comm=Dog), Amul, Amazon.

Ansoff Matrix (Product-Market Matrix)

- **Market Penetration** (existing product, existing market) — lowest risk, e.g. Buy-Now-Pay-Later to cut purchase friction.
- **Product Development** (new product, existing market) — e.g. Britannia's Potatоз.

- **Market Development** (existing product, new market) — e.g. OYO in China, Zomato in UAE.
- **Diversification** (new product, new market) — highest risk; Related (Adani into green energy) vs Unrelated (Bajaj into finance via Bajaj Finserv).

9. Pricing Strategies (9 types)

Premium (Ferrari), Penetration (aviation), Predatory (telecom price wars — can be anti-competitive/illegal), Geographical (fuel, alcohol — driven by taxes/PPP), Price Skimming (new smartphones), Psychological (₹199 vs ₹200), Dynamic (airlines/cabs), Captive Product (razor cheap, blades priced high), Bundle (multi-product packs).

10. B2B vs B2C

	B2C	B2B
Ticket size	Small	Large
Driver	Promotion/emotion	Efficiency/cost
Relationship	Short-term	Long-term
Decision	Simple, single decision-maker	Multi-level, committee-based

Digital Marketing/Purchase Funnel (10 stages): Engagement → Education → Research → Evaluation → Justification → Purchase → Adoption → Retention → Expansion → Advocacy.

11. Product Life Cycle (PLC)

- Stages: R&D → Introduction → Growth → Maturity → Decline.
- **PLC Extension** tactics: facelifts (Hyundai Creta vs Kia Seltos), flanker brands (Tata Tiago → Altroz to fight Baleno), software suite expansion (MS Office).

12. Brand Fundamentals

- **Brand** = the perception/emotional bond a customer has with a product; a **trademark** is the legally protected name/mark.
- **Brand Experience** (sum of all touchpoints) vs **Brand Image** (the mental construct in the customer's head).
- **Brand Value** (financial worth, based on discounted future cash flows) vs **Brand Equity** (customer attitude/willingness to pay more) — a classic "explain the difference" interview question.
- **Brand Value Chain**: Marketing investment → Customer mindset (awareness, attitude) → Market performance (price premium, elasticity) → Shareholder value.

Brand Rivalry

- Exists to win new customers, win rival's customers, or win a larger share of shared/multi-homing customers.
- Examples: Visa vs Mastercard, Coke vs Pepsi, McDonald's vs Burger King.
- Benefits: builds loyalty, sympathy for smaller brands, free attention. Risks: can boost the rival's own visibility ("awakening a sleeping brand").

Brand Personality / 12 Archetypes

Framework: brands adopt human-like personality archetypes (Explorer, Innocent, Sage, Rebel, etc.) so customers form an emotional connection — 80% of purchase decisions are said to be made before conscious rational thought.

Brand Identity Prism (Kapferer, 1996)

Six facets: **Physique** (physical/visual cues), **Personality** (tone of voice), **Culture** (values), **Relationship** (brand-customer bond), **Reflection** (stereotypical user), **Self-Image** (how the customer sees their ideal self).

Brand Cannibalization

- New product eats into an existing product's sales without growing total market share.
- "If you don't cannibalize yourself, someone else will" — Apple's yearly iPhone launches, Coca-Cola's flavor extensions (later ring-fenced by re-branding original as "Classic Coke"), Starbucks over-expansion cannibalizing its own premium positioning.

13. Consumer Psychology & Behavioural Marketing

- **Classical Conditioning**: pairing a neutral stimulus with an existing response (Coca-Cola's "Thanda Matlab Coca-Cola" linked existing "Thanda" positivity to the brand).
- **Operant Conditioning**: reinforcement/punishment shapes repeat behaviour (Starbucks Rewards = positive reinforcement; Fair & Lovely-type ads = negative reinforcement, i.e., relieving an implied "problem").

- **AIDA Model** (Attention → Interest → Desire → Action): classic linear funnel of a purchase decision; criticized for ignoring post-purchase behaviour.
- **Framing Effect**: how information is presented changes decisions — Gain frame, Loss/FOMO frame, Statistics frame, Emotion frame ("30% less sugar" framing).
- **Psychology of Selling**: buyers respond to speed of response (call within 5 minutes of an inquiry), respecting their time, persistence (50% of sales close only after the 5th follow-up attempt), solving problems (not excuse-making), and avoiding choice overload.
- **Goldilocks Effect**: buyers gravitate to the mid-priced "just right" option among three choices (classic 3-tier pricing psychology used by Dollar Shave Club).

14. "Interesting Concepts" Cluster

- **Co-branding**: two brands partnering for mutual value (Lay's x Cadbury/KFC/Zomato/Spotify "HeartWork" campaign); risk = cross-contamination if partner brand gets into controversy.
- **Surrogate Marketing**: since India (ASCI) bans direct liquor/tobacco ads, brands promote via a "communicating product" (Bagpiper Soda for Bagpiper Whiskey), proxy commercials, movie placements, or sponsorships.
- **Guerrilla Marketing**: low-cost, high-creativity, unconventional campaigns designed to surprise (outdoor, indoor, experiential/viral types).
- **Meme Marketing**: leveraging shareable cultural content, especially to reach ad-averse Gen Z (Heinz's fruit-vs-vegetable meme, Zomato meme-jacking trends).

- **Emotional Marketing:** uses core emotions — happiness, sorrow, anger, fear — to drive engagement and recall (P&G "Like a Girl", WWF sorrow-based campaigns).
- **Cause Marketing:** businesses tie sales/actions to a social cause — forms include Portion-of-Purchase, Transactional Campaigns, Point-of-Sale asks, Buy-One-Give-One. Notable FMCG-relevant examples: **Tata Tea "Jaago Re"** (moved TCP's tea business from #2 to #1 market share), **Lifebuoy "Gondappa"** (handwashing behaviour change, reduced diarrhoea incidence 36%→5%), Horlicks "Ahaar Abhiyan" (14% sales lift in West Bengal).

15. Rural Marketing (highly relevant to your GT/pharma territories)

- Rural ≠ scaled-down urban — requires a fresh strategy ("unlearn urban rules").
- **4 A's framework:** **Availability** (deep distribution trade-off), **Awareness** (traditional ATL — TV/radio), **Acceptability** (adapting the product to local usage), **Affordability** (small/low-unit-price SKUs, credit/loans).
- Mix tweaks: smaller SKUs (CavinKare's 50-paisa Chik shampoo sachets, Coke's ₹5 SKU), rural-specific distribution (haats, melas, hub-and-spoke, self-help groups, van/mobile trade, ITC e-Choupal), rural-specific promotion (wall paintings, folk theatre, mobile publicity vans, opinion-leader endorsement).

16. Service Marketing

- Marketing for intangible offerings; centers on the **Service Marketing Triangle** (Company–Employees–Consumer).

- 4 service types by tangibility/target: People Processing (salon), Possession Processing (packers & movers), Mental Stimulus Processing (education/training), Information Processing (IT/SAP-type services).
- Example: Urban Company's Salon-at-Home.

17. Digital Marketing & Ecommerce

- **7 channels:** Email/SMS/Push, SEM, SEO, Display, Social Media, Content Marketing, Affiliate Marketing.
- **5 principles:** find where prospects are, measure & optimize continuously, and personalize (demographic/geographic/behavioral/user-level).
- **Closed-Loop Marketing:** tracking a lead across the full funnel (visitor → lead → customer) via cookies/CRM to connect marketing spend to actual sales outcomes.
- **E-commerce models:** B2C, B2B, C2C, C2B (reverse model – e.g., iStockPhoto), B2A/C2A (with government/administration).

18. Startups / India Startup Ecosystem

- Definition, funding stages (personal, angel, seed), and why India's unicorn ecosystem is now globally significant (compared with US/China) – largely context/general-knowledge material, lower priority for your interview.

PART 2: LIKELY INTERVIEW QUESTIONS FOR YOUR PPI

(TECHNICAL COMPETENCE – MT ROLE)

Round 1 was about *the MT role itself*; Round 2 tests whether you can **think and speak like a Sales MT** – connect this theory to what you actually saw on the ground in Vadodara, Ahmedabad, and Surat. Expect a mix of (A) technical/conceptual, (B) internship-specific, and (C) situational/case questions.

A. Core S&D concepts they will almost certainly probe

1. Walk me through the flow of a product from TCP's factory to the final consumer. Where does the pharma channel differ from general trade?
2. What is the difference between Primary, Secondary, and Tertiary sales? Why do sales managers focus more on secondary/tertiary than primary?
3. What is a C&F agent's role? A stockist's? A super-stockist's? (Be ready to distinguish urban stockist vs rural super-stockist.)
4. How does margin distribution work across the channel – and what happens when a retailer/stockist feels the margin is too thin?
5. What's the difference between General Trade, Modern Trade, and E-commerce as channels, and how does TCP/Tata approach each?
6. Explain planogramming – why does shelf placement matter, and what did you observe in pharmacies/chemist outlets on your beat?

B. Questions that will directly reference your internship

7. Why does a pharma-sector sales channel look different from a typical FMCG (kirana) channel? (Think: prescription influence, chemist relationships, stockist licensing/drug laws, cold-chain/expiry sensitivity, lower footfall but higher basket value per SKU.)
8. What specific challenges did you face covering Vadodara, Ahmedabad, and Surat — market maturity differences, competitive intensity, retailer relationships?
9. Give an example of a distributor/retailer issue you resolved or observed being resolved.
10. What did a typical "market working" day look like for you? (They want to hear beat plan, outlet coverage, order booking, scheme communication, competitor tracking.)
11. What KPI would you use to judge whether your territory's secondary sales were healthy, beyond just the primary billing number?

C. Framework application — expect them to ask you to apply a model to TCP, not just define it

12. Do a quick SWOT of TCP's presence in the market you worked in.
13. Where would you place TCP's various brands (Tata Salt, Tata Tea/Tetley, Sampann, Tata Sampann, Tata Coffee, etc.) on a BCG matrix?
14. If TCP wanted to grow in your Pharma-adjacent territory, which Ansoff strategy (penetration/development/diversification) would you recommend, and why?

15. Apply the 4 A's of rural marketing to a smaller town near Surat/Vadodara/Ahmedabad you may have visited.

D. Situational / case-style (common in Technical Competence rounds for MT roles)

16. A key stockist threatens to stop stocking your brand because a competitor is offering a better margin. What do you do?
17. Sales in one outlet cluster are flat despite good distribution (numeric availability). What could be going wrong, and how would you diagnose it? (Point to planogram/visibility, pricing vs competition, scheme awareness, stock-outs on hero SKUs.)
18. You're asked to launch a new SKU designed for price-sensitive, high-footfall outlets. Walk through your go-to-market thinking using the 4Ps.

E. Behavioral / "why MT" wrap-up questions

19. What did this internship teach you about the gap between marketing theory and on-ground sales execution?
20. Why do you want to be a Management Trainee, and how does your Pharma/India Sales internship prepare you for the rotational, generalist nature of an MT program?
21. What would you do differently if given the same territory again?

Quick-reference "if they ask you to define X in one line" cheat sheet

- **Marketing vs Selling** → Pull vs Push.
- **Primary/Secondary/Tertiary sales** →
Company→Distributor / Distributor→Retailer /
Retailer→Consumer.
- **BCG** → Share × Growth → Star/Cash Cow/Question
Mark/Dog.
- **Ansoff** → Product × Market →
Penetration/Development/Development/Diversification.
- **STP** → Segment → Target → Position; test segments with
MSADA.
- **POP vs POD** → Shared attribute vs unique/owned
attribute.
- **Brand Equity vs Brand Value** → Customer
attitude/willingness to pay vs financial/monetary worth of
the brand.
- **AIDA** → Attention → Interest → Desire → Action.
- **4 A's (Rural)** → Availability, Awareness, Acceptability,
Affordability.

Tip for the round: whenever a concept comes up, anchor your answer with a concrete example from Vadodara/Ahmedabad/Surat rather than a textbook FMCG example – that's what will differentiate you from other candidates who've only read the theory.